

Ἀνώνυμοι Ἰατρικοί

Anonymous Medical Writers on the Human Body

eul_aid: umi

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἰατρική [Medicine](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

The designation Medical Writers Anonymous refers to a collection of about two dozen Greek medical handbooks written between the 1st and 6th centuries CE. The authors of these practical texts are unknown, a common feature for technical works where the utility of the information was more important than the fame of the writer. According to modern scholars, these anonymous writers were likely practicing physicians or teachers working within the broad tradition of Greek medicine, possibly based in major centers like Alexandria or Constantinople.

Their surviving works include treatises on topics such as acute and chronic diseases, women's health, urine analysis, pulse diagnosis, medical ethics, and drug recipes. Written in straightforward, technical Greek, these texts served as guides for doctors and students. They compiled and simplified knowledge from earlier authorities like Hippocrates and Galen, while also incorporating folk remedies and everyday practices.

This anonymous corpus is significant because it provides a window into the mainstream medical practice of the Roman and early Byzantine periods, beyond the theories of famous individual doctors. The texts show how classical medical knowledge was adapted for daily use in diagnosis and treatment. Their influence was long-lasting; they were translated into Syriac, Arabic, and Latin and became foundational sources for medical knowledge in the Middle Ages and Renaissance. Their collective, anonymous nature itself highlights a tradition where practical knowledge was often treated as a shared professional resource.

Works (24)

- [Κόσμος Μηνῶν](#) · [Adornment of the Months](#) · 30 passages
- [Ὑπόμνημα εἰς Οὔρα](#) · [Commentary-Urines](#) · 10 passages
- [Διάγνωσις περὶ τῶν ὀξέων καὶ χρονίων νοσημάτων](#) · [Diagnosis of Acute and Chronic Diseases](#) · 35 passages
- [Διάφορα Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Medical Fragments](#) · 10 passages
- [Ὄνομασiai τῶν κατὰ ἄνθρωπον](#) · [Names of Human Parts, Book 1](#) · 72 passages
- [Ὄνόματα τῶν ἱατρικῶν ἐργαλείων κατὰ στοιχεῖα οἷς](#) · [Names of Medical Instruments by Element Used in Surgeries](#) · 3 passages
- [Περὶ Διαιτῆς](#) · [On Diet](#) · 22 passages
- [Περὶ Τροφῶν](#) · [On Foods \(Long Treatise\)](#) · 80 passages
- [Περὶ Τροφῶν](#) · [On Foods \(Short Treatise\)](#) · 29 passages
- [Περὶ Γενέσεως καὶ Σπέρματος](#) · [On Generation and Seed](#) · 15 passages
- [Περὶ λυκανθρωπίας](#) · [On Lycanthropy](#) · 1 passages

- [Περὶ Σφυγμῶν · On Pulses](#) · 3 passages
- [Περὶ Ἀφορισμῶν Ἱπποκράτους · On the Aphorisms of Hippocrates](#) · 1 passages
- [Περὶ χροῖαῖς τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ ἀπὸ φλεβοτομίας ἐκ τῆς · On the Color of Blood from Phlebotomy in Persian Medicine](#) · 9 passages
- [Περὶ τῆς τῶν πυρετῶν διαφορᾶς · On the Difference of Fevers](#) · 10 passages
- [Περὶ Φύσεως Ἀνθρώπου · On the Nature of Man](#) · 10 passages
- [Περὶ Φύσεως Ἀνθρωπίνου Σώματος · On the Nature of the Human Body](#) · 6 passages
- [Περὶ Φύσεως Δώδεκα Μηνῶν · On the Nature of Twelve Months](#) · 49 passages
- [Περὶ τροφῶν δυνάμεως · On the Power of Foods](#) · 13 passages
- [Περὶ Οὔρων κατὰ Πέρσας · On Urine According to the Persians](#) · 1 passages
- [Περὶ Οὔρων κατὰ Σύρους · On Urine According to the Syrians](#) · 6 passages
- [Περὶ Οὔρων ἐν Πυρετοῖς · On Urine in Fevers](#) · 5 passages
- [Ὄνοματοποιία τῆς ἀνθρώπου φύσεως · Onomatopoeia of Human Nature](#) · 2 passages
- [Φυσιογνωμονικά · Physiognomics](#) · 22 passages